

Incident handler's journal

Instructions

As you continue through this course, you may use this template to record your findings after completing an activity or to take notes on what you've learned about a specific tool or concept. You can also use this journal as a way to log the key takeaways about the different cybersecurity tools or concepts you encounter in this course.

Date: 11-08-2026	**Entry:** 1
Description	The organization experienced a security incident on Tuesday at 9:00 a.m. which severely disrupted their business operations.
Tool(s) used	None
The 5 W's	• External threats caused the incident, an organized group of unethical hackers • Several employees reported that they were unable to use their computers to access files like medical records. Business operations shut down because employees were unable to access the files and software needed to do their job. • The incident occurred on Tuesday at 9:00 a.m • The incident happened at a small U.S. health care clinic specializing in delivering primary-care services • The incident happened because several employees were targeted by phishing emails that contained a malicious attachment. Once it was downloaded, ransomware was deployed encrypting the organization's computer files.

Additional notes	• The lack of awareness on phishing attacks was a missing control, threat actors used the email attachments as the attack vector. • Emails with attachments were not filtered to detect any malware or suspicious files. • The business operations could not be restored soon as it lacked daily backups.

Date: 25-08-2026	**Entry:** 2
Description	Investigating a suspicious file hash
Tool(s) used	VirusTotal
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • Advanced threat actor called “BlackTech” • The malware triggered IDS and caused a security incident • The incident occurred at 1:11 pm • The incident happened in an employee's computer • The attachment was downloaded and executed by the employee
Additional notes	Upon running the SHA256 file hash: 54e6ea47eb04634d3e87fd7787e2136ccfbcc80ade34f246a12cf93bab527f6b on VirusTotal the file has been identified as malicious. 52/71 security vendors flagged this file as malicious. It has a Community Score of -293. And 3 Dynamic Analysis Sandbox Detections flag is as MALWARE.

Date: Record the date of the journal entry.	**Entry:** Record the journal entry number.
Description	Use a playbook to respond to a phishing incident
Tool(s) used	List any cybersecurity tools that were used.
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • **Who** caused the incident? • **What** happened? • **When** did the incident occur? • **Where** did the incident happen? • **Why** did the incident happen?
Additional notes	Include any additional thoughts, questions, or findings.

Date: Record the date of the journal entry.	**Entry:** Record the journal entry number.
Description	Provide a brief description about the journal entry.
Tool(s) used	List any cybersecurity tools that were used.
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • **Who** caused the incident? • **What** happened?

	• **When** did the incident occur? • **Where** did the incident happen? • **Why** did the incident happen?
Additional notes	Include any additional thoughts, questions, or findings.

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Additional notes	Include any additional thoughts, questions, or findings.

Need another journal entry template?

If you want to add more journal entries, please copy one of the tables above and paste it into the template to use for future entries.

Reflections/Notes: Record additional notes.